D.J. PARIS

1.33 MILLION HOME SALES NEVER HAPPENED.

The reason your hesitant seller won't list isn't the market. It's their mortgage rate.

D.J. Paris
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FEDERAL HOUSING RESEARCHERS FOUND THAT FOR EVERY PERCENTAGE POINT TODAY'S RATE SITS ABOVE A HOMEOWNER'S OWN RATE, THE ODDS THEY SELL DROP BY 18.1 PERCENT.

That is not a seller being difficult. That is a seller doing math.

03 / 05

MOST AGENTS READ "NOT NOW" AS "NOT MOTIVATED."

The data says otherwise. A seller sitting on a rate from a few years ago isn't comparing their house to the comps, they're comparing their current payment to what a new loan on their next house would cost them every month, and right now that gap is real money. Some are solving it without you: the share of homes listed for rent on Zillow that were previously listed for sale hit its second-highest level in nearly six years this year. If you don't bring up the math, they go find their own answer, and it might not involve selling at all.

WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY THIS MONTH:

1 **Ask for their current rate before you ask for their timeline.**

The number stopping them is their rate, not the market.

2 **Run the monthly payment gap with them, in dollars, on paper.**

Their current payment next to the payment on their likely next home at today's rate. Not percentages, actual numbers.

3 **Bring up renting instead of selling, yourself, first.**

Some sellers will choose it over listing. Raise it before they do and you stay their agent either way.

THE TAKEAWAY

HERE'S WHAT YOU DO NOW.

Pull your hesitant-seller list today. Call the top three and ask one question: what rate are you on right now? Build the math with them before you build the pitch.

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